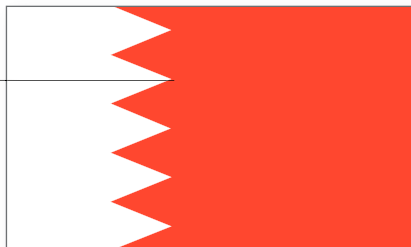


Bahrain

Ratio: 3:5 **Adopted:** 2002 **Usage:** National and Civil

*The serrated edge
was originally a
straight line*



Red and white
are the traditional
colors of the Gulf
states

Asia



Despite Iran's claims of sovereignty, **Bahrain**, an archipelago in the Gulf, has retained its independence gained from Great Britain in 1971.

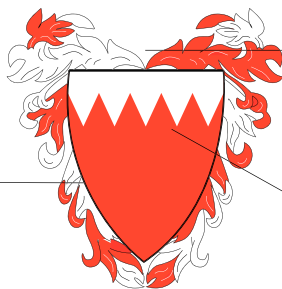
Bahrain was under British protection from 1820 to 1971. By the terms of the General Maritime Treaty of 1820, all friendly states in the Gulf undertook to add white borders to their red flags, so that they would not be taken for pirate flags. The various states of the "Pirate Coast" then developed flags

with differing white patterns on them. A plain vertical white strip was added to Bahrain's flag. In 1932 the line was made serrated. In 2002, Bahrain became a kingdom and the number of serrations was set at five.

The national arms was adopted in 1932. It is based on the colors and design of the national flag.

ARMS OF BAHRAIN

The coat of arms dates from 1932; it was designed by Sir Charles Belgrave, the Sheik's political adviser



Until independence in 1971, there was an oriental crown above the shield

The shield contains the characteristic serrated division line, as on the national flag